

The Agentic Funnel

Preparing a booking site for AI agents that browse, compare and act

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Every statistic is attributed to a source listed on the final page. Sources reviewed October 2026.

Agents don't just advise. They act.

Google defines AI agents as autonomous systems that carry out tasks for people, such as booking a reservation or comparing specifications. Browser agents may visit a site and read it through screenshots, the DOM and the accessibility tree [5].

The Chrome team writes that some users are now delegating goal-oriented journeys to agents [7]. Google notes that protocols such as the Universal Commerce Protocol are emerging to let Search agents do more [5].



Illustration of the journey described above; the stages are the author's framing.

Three views, often combined.

View	What the agent gets [7]
Screenshots	A vision model identifies elements. Slow and costly, so often a fallback when structure is confusing.
HTML / DOM	Nesting, hierarchy and attributes. A Buy button inside a product container is read as belonging to that product.
Accessibility tree	Roles, names and states of interactive elements: a semantic summary that ignores visual noise.

Modern agents cross-reference these views. A further layer, WebMCP, is a proposed standard that lets sites declare tasks explicitly. The Chrome team labels it in active development and available as an origin trial [7].

The practical checklist.

FROM GOOGLE'S WEB.DEV GUIDANCE [7]

- Avoid transparent overlays that hide interactive elements.
- Use semantic HTML: real button and a elements, not styled div or span.
- Link each label to its input with the for attribute.
- Make interactive elements visible and larger than 8 square pixels.
- Keep layouts stable, with key buttons in consistent places.
- Consider WebMCP tools, with caution: still experimental.

Google's authors note that everything which makes a site agent-ready also makes it better for people [7].

What Microsoft says to avoid.

- Long walls of text that blur ideas together [3].
- Important answers hidden in tabs or expandable menus, which AI systems may not render [3].
- Core information only in PDFs, which lack the headings and metadata HTML provides [3].
- Key details only in images: provide alt text or put them in HTML [3].

Google likewise recommends that important content be available in text form [4].

Note on this document: it is a PDF for reading. On a live booking site, rates, policies and availability belong in plain HTML.

A page-level audit grid.

Step	What an agent needs	Source
Find	Clear title, H1 and description that agree	[3]
Judge fit	Sleeps, bedrooms, pool, house rules as lists or tables, not hidden tabs	[3]
Check dates and price	Visible rates and availability; labelled form fields	[3][7]
Book	Un-obscured, semantic Book button; stable layout	[7]
Trust	Any structured data matches visible text	[4]

The grid is the author's synthesis of the cited guidance, offered as an audit starting point rather than a sourced finding.

What is not established.

- WebMCP is a proposed standard still in active development [7].
- Google describes protocols such as UCP as emerging, not as settled practice [5].
- Google says no special schema is needed for its AI features [5].
- Claims that specific schema properties (for example dateModified) cause agents to complete bookings were not found in the Google, Microsoft or web.dev material reviewed.

The safest position: build clean, accessible, accurate pages, test with real agents, and revisit as standards settle.

Mapped to the role.

The role asks for	This guidance supports
Define how content is structured so AI parses and cites it	Specific facts; markup that matches the page [3][4]
Work with developers on technical foundations	Agent-friendly front end checklist [7]
Audit appearance across AI platforms	Repeated query testing, one platform at a time (the 6-query audit)
Track and report visibility over time	Search Console Generative AI report for Google [5]

Left column paraphrases the Perfect Hideaways job advert.

References

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